

Q.2b (15 marks): Cultural practices and beliefs can be understood as adaptive responses to environmental and economic constraints. Comment.

b)

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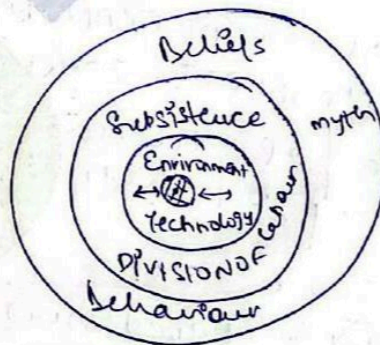
Culture is adaptive and its responses are based on environmental and economic constraints. It can be elaborated by:-

- ① Neoevolutionism
- ② Historical Particularism & Diffusion
- ③ Functionalism
- ④ Cultural Materialism

① NEOEVOLUTIONISM :-

1.1) Julian Steward said that culture is evolution in BIOCULTURAL manner. Each area has own ways of using the environmental mechanism.

CULTURE & ECOLOGY :-

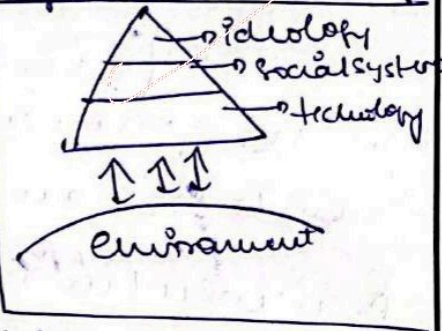


□ = culture core

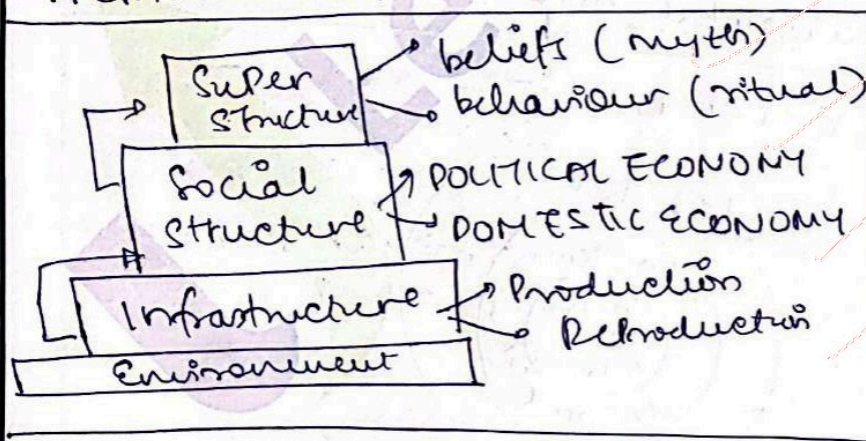
- He said)
- a) Culture core interacts with environmental constraints
 - b) The technology and subsistence is based on these factors
 - c) These decide the beliefs etc.

(2) Leslie White 'Technological Determinism'

Technology system is based on energy harnessed from the environment. This in turn impacts ideology, practices, beliefs.



(2) Cultural Materialism :- Marvin Harris in "The Rise of Anthropological Thought" gave concept of "infrastructure determinism". The culture sustains if infrastructure (production and reproduction) is maintained.



In India's Sacred Cow, he said cow provides fuel, fertiliser and nutrients thereby ensuring subsistence and population survival. Thus it aids kishik bonds and becomes SACRED (Superstructure).

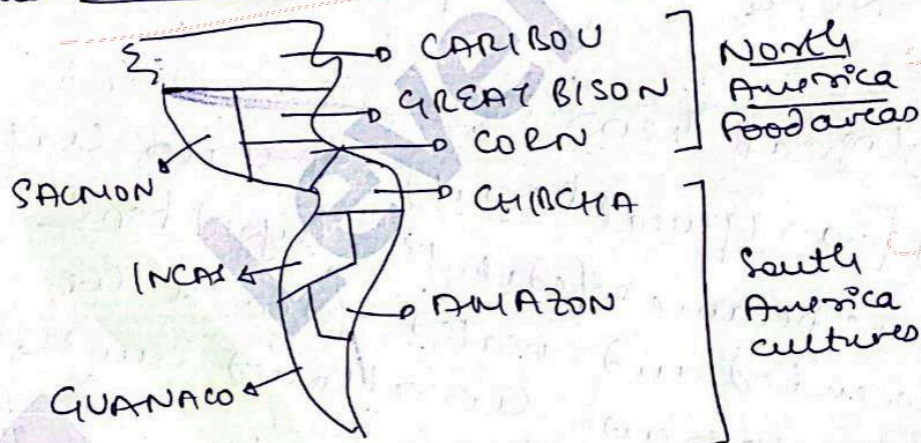
③ Historical Particularism and Diffusion

Frank Boas said that ③ factors decide culture development :-

- a) Psychology of people
 - b) resources used
 - c) environment
- } along with climate & borrowing.

Based on this ^{classical} culture area and culture intensity/climax of Kroeber were got.

Culture areas of Clark on per environment and economic factors:-



Thus environment and economy decide the culture

④ Malinowski said Culture is need surveying and needfuling system that propagates as long as environmental & economic needs are fulfilled.

POST MODERNISTS criticise that there is NO SEPARATION OF NATURE AND CULTURE.